



Oct 5, 2026

Biobank Working Group

Agenda

- 12:00-12:05 Updates
  - Webpage
  - Zoo Biology paper is out!
  - IMLS Letter of Support by Oct 30
  - Underlay demo (9am PT/12pm ET Friday 10/9)
- 12:05-12:50 Read out objectives to plenary
- 12:50-1:25 Incorporate input in breakouts
- 1:25-1:30 Wrap-up



Objectives: Discoverability

By 2032, biological samples and associated data from across participating zoological and aquarium institutions are seamlessly *discoverable* for the global advancement of non-commercial research and conservation.

- By 2028, participating institutions have a designated point of contact for inquiries about their sample collection in a public, globally searchable directory.
- By 2029, have defined what the searchable discoverability system is and what it looks like.
- By 2030, participating institutions have entered samples of a shared target taxon into a public database.
- By 2030, participating institutions have begun beta testing search functionality with participating institutions and select research partners.
- By 2031, a beta version of a searchable database can be used by participating institutions to add samples and associated data records.

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- By 2031, a beta version of a searchable database can be used by participating institutions to add samples and associated data records.
- **By 2032, biological samples and associated data from across participating zoological and aquarium institutions are *accessible* from the Biobank Alliance.**
- By 2028, have developed mutually agreed upon predefined conditions for accessing biobanked samples.
- By 2029, have developed a central request process through the Biobank Alliance.
- By 2030, have an established review and approval process through the Biobank Alliance.
- By 2031, a system has been implemented by five institutions for the pre-defined criteria, such that researchers can access samples through that system.
- **By 2032, a standardized biobanking framework is in use by participating zoos and aquariums.**
- 1. By 2027, the Biobank Alliance Working Group has defined a consensus-based framework for community standards of practice.
- 2. By 2031, the biobanking framework has been piloted and evaluated by institutions participating in the Biobank Alliance.
    - 2. By 2028, operational standards of practice have been generated.
- 3. By 2032, a plan for scalability and recruitment for the refined biobanking framework is in place.

Objectives: Access

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Objectives: Standardization

By 2032, a standardized biobanking framework ~~related to sample collection and metadata entry~~ is in use by participating zoos and aquariums.

1. By 2027, the Biobank Alliance Working Group has defined a consensus-based participation model for ~~community standards of practice~~ coordinated biobanking.
2. By 2031, the biobanking framework has been piloted and evaluated by institutions participating in the Biobank Alliance.
    - By 2028, operational standards of practice have been generated.
3. By 2032, a plan for scalability and recruitment for the refined biobanking framework is in place.

Wrap-up

- Homework
  - Underlay demo (9am PT/12pm ET **this Friday** 10/9)
  - Sign IMLS letter by 10/30
- Next meeting: Monday November 2

